

Awards

Kunwer Sachdev wins 'Entrepreneur Of The Year' Award 2011

Kunwer Sachdev, managing director, Su-kam Power Systems, has been conferred with the 'Entrepreneur of the Year 2011' award for achieving remarkable success in his entrepreneurial venture.

Entrepreneur India Awards instituted by Franchise India aim to recognise and felicitate achievers, innovators and suppliers who have contributed significantly towards the development of entrepreneurship in India. In all, there were seventeen award categories spanning across different business sectors.



Kunwer Sachdev with the award

Infotech recognised as the best Indian company

Infotech Enterprises has been recognised as the 'Best Indian Company' located in south India doing business in the US, by Indo-American Chamber of Commerce (IACC) South India Council (SIC). The award was presented at the launch of 'Southern Star Awards' in Bengaluru.

The awards have been instituted with a view to recognise its members who have advocated good business between India and the US, further fostering the spirit of Indo-US business cooperation.

voice services, including value added services and SMS form just five to fifteen per cent of total operator revenues, which goes to over 50 per cent for operators in major countries. Also, rural tele-density has still not reached the targets and the universal service obligation (USO) fund created for the telecom industry has not been utilised adequately.

The report stated that only about 25 per cent graduates in India have the skills that deem them fit to work for multinational companies. This is because most institutes in India are built with the idea of meeting the demand for graduate education, focused on enrolling as many students as possible."

Sibal's 'carrot and stick' policy for BSNL

Telecom minister Kapil Sibal is planning to adopt a 'carrot-and-stick' policy to turnaround state-owned firm BSNL, which posted a net loss of Rs 18.23 billion on revenue of Rs 320.46 billion in 2009-10.

"The point is we must have targets for circles. If you don't, you will be transferred out and those who will do well will be rewarded; may be they should

be given a posting of their choice. The kind of assets BSNL has, nobody else can have in this country. We need to use those assets for profit for public service ultimately. If you run at a loss you get subsidies and then all that money goes down the drain," said Sibal.

The Department of Telecom (DoT) has instructed all the 24 territorial circles to realise 25 per cent growth in their revenues on year-on-year basis, failing which they will be denied their monthly funds allocation.

DoT's Rs 300 million plan for new net protocol

The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has charted out a Rs 300 million plan to implement the new Internet protocol version (IPv6) across the country by March next year.

The plan includes setting up trial laboratories and training modules to create awareness about the new protocol. The new standard is designed to offer improved address space, quality of service and data security capabilities.

As part of the implementation DoT has given Rs 5.2 million to BSNL to conduct 26 IPv6 awareness workshops

across the country. Officials from various central and state departments will be given training on the new Internet Protocol. Another Rs 100 million is being given to BSNL for setting up laboratories to give demonstrations and hands-on experience on how the new protocol works.

Celkon plans Rs 1000 million assembly plant

Celkon Mobiles, which launched its range of dual-SIM mobiles in south India last year, is planning to establish a Rs 1000 million mobile assembly unit in southern India by next year.

The company is in initial discussions with the governments of Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Karnataka for locating its assembling facility, which will be producing 3.6 million pieces annually.

"The India assembling facility will allow us to do away with the Chinese firm, helping us to significantly improve our margins. While we propose to assemble low-end mobile handsets at the Indian facility, we will continue to import high-end gadgets such as touch screen mobiles, android phones and tablets at least for a few more years till we acquire the capabilities to assemble them locally," said Y. Guru, managing director, Celkon.

Telecom panel approves Rs 200 billion for broadband network

Telecom Commission has given its approval to the proposed national optical fibre network (NOFN) for offering broadband services in rural areas. The network, to be built at an estimated cost of Rs 200 billion, will connect all the *gram panchayats*. The project will be funded by the universal services obligation (USO) fund.

"The objective of the scheme is to extend initially the existing optical fibre network from districts headquarters'/block headquarters' level up to the *gram panchayat* level by utilising USO fund. The cost of the initial phase of the NOFN scheme is likely to be in the region of Rs 200 billion. Similar